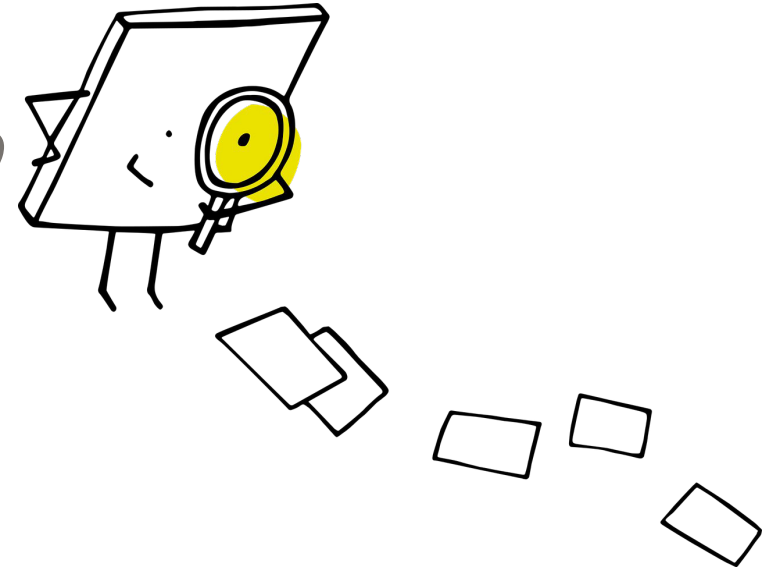


Lesson 5: Claim, Reason & Evidence

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Today's learning objective

**Identify and evaluate evidence
in a text or other content.**

Claim of argumentative writing

A claim delivers some opinion(s) about what the author wants the readers to believe or act for.

“I like this article of Forbes magazine on writing education.”

Is it a claim? Why or why not?
If not, how can we make it a claim?

“Curricular writing exercise benefits engineering students’ critical thinking skill development in processing written information.”

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“I like this article of Forbes magazine on writing education.”

Is it a claim? Why or why not?
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“This article on Forbes magazine seems to undervalue the role of non-AI engineering and science fields in the development of AI.”

Evidence for a claim

Textual evidence will answer WHY the author believes curricular writing exercise benefits engineering students.

What else should we do if we include this evidence in our writing?

In [1], Nadeem and colleagues found that “[writing practice] stimulated students to learn, and apply their knowledge to solve real-world problems and provide constructive feedback on peers’ work.”

Types of evidence

Facts

Statistics

Expert opinions

Personal experience

Quotations from other sources



What evidence did the “anti-cookie” side provide that cookies should be outlawed?

Prep for group work



Individually read the article "How Much Language Do Dogs Really Understand?" to identify

- claims, and
- textual evidence that supports each claim.

Group activity

You have read the article “How Much Language Do Dogs Really Understand?”

Step 1: List at least two claims together.

Step 2: Identify all pieces of textual evidence for each claim.

Step 3: Label what type of evidence is being used: Are they facts, statistics, expert opinions, personal experiences, or quotations?

Debrief

What claims has your group found?

What types of textual evidence did you find?

Did the text provide enough evidence to support its claims?

Why or why not?

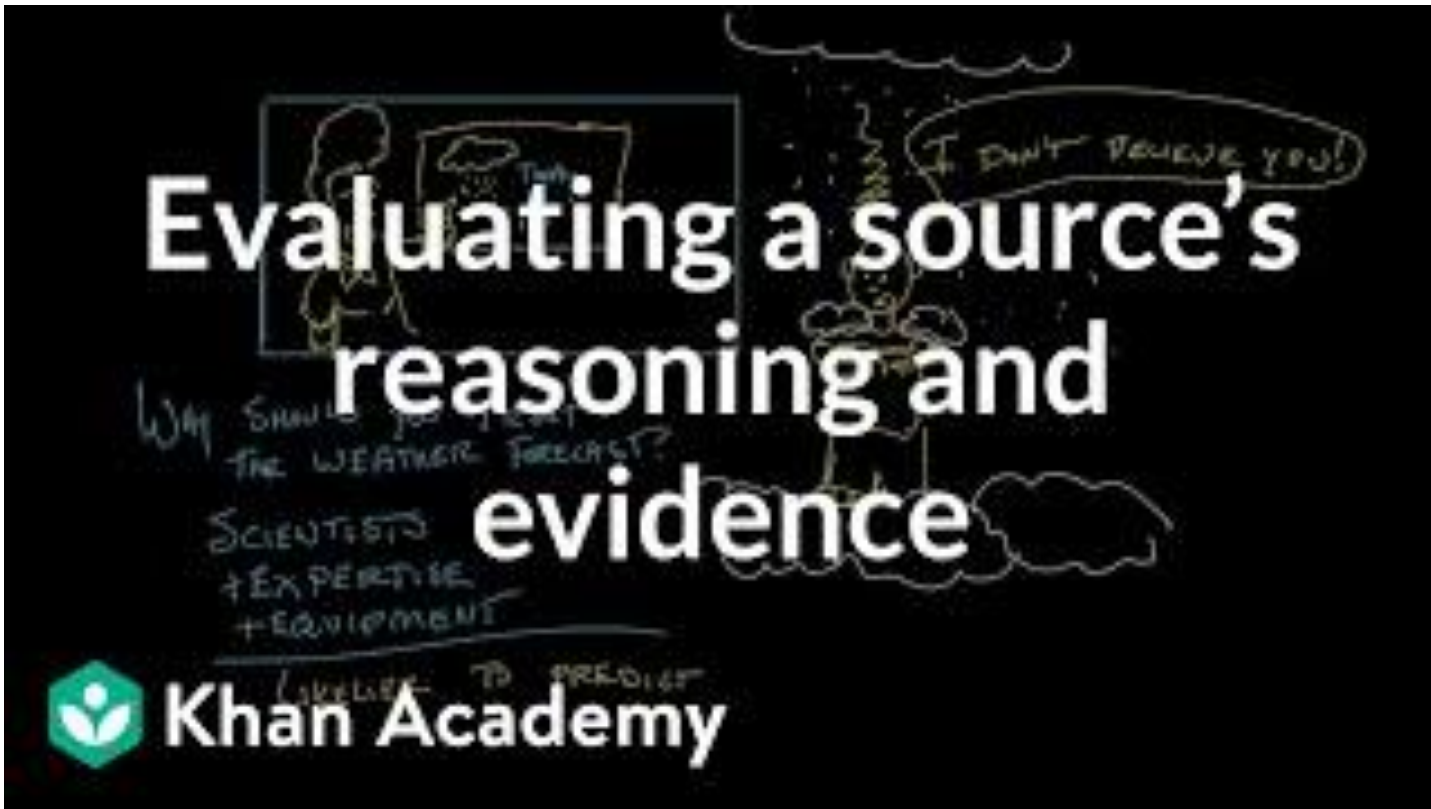
Claim and evidence

As we have seen, argumentative writing has one or more claims.

Claims need evidence.

Is that it? Is there some other component required?

Claims, evidence & analysis



Primary & secondary source

Primary Source - Firsthand, original account.

Example: News interviews with Joshimath residents about their recent experience about land subsidence in Joshimath, Uttarakhand

Examples of types:

- Texts of laws and other original documents
- Newspaper reports, by reporters who witnessed an event
- Speeches, letters and interviews
- Original research providing new data usually through “methodology” and “results”
- Datasets, survey data, such as census or economic statistics
- Photographs, video, or audio that capture an event

Secondary Source - Works that analyze, assess or interpret; often offer a review or a critique

Example: An opinion piece diagnosing likely causes of the Joshimath subsidence and discussing preventive measures.

Examples of types:

- Most textbooks about a topic
- Analysis or interpretation of data
- Literature reviews and meta-analyses
- Biographies and documentaries (though they often include photos or video portions that can be considered primary sources)
- Editorials and opinions

Primary or secondary?

Poem

Biography

Biology
textbook

Diary

How do I know if the evidence is strong?

Strong evidence offers **proof** of the claim, and must meet the following criteria:

- **C**redible: Is the source reliable?
- **R**elevant: Does the evidence actually prove what is being claimed?
- **S**ufficient: Is there enough evidence, and enough types of evidence?

Pair activity (10 mins)

- Evaluate Gentry's claims, evidence, and analyses on *Psychology Today* with your partner.
- Write down the following:
 - What is the main claim, or thesis statement?
 - What must be proved?
 - What evidence does he provide? Is it C-R-S?
 - What analysis does he make? Does it make sense?



J. R. Gentry. "Why the Human Brain Needs Spelling." *Psychology Today*, Jan. 2025. [Online]
Available:
<https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/raising-readers-writers-and-spellers/202501/why-the-human-brain-needs-spelling>

Parify (5 mins)

Two pairs exchange their evaluation with each other.

- What is the main claim, or thesis statement?
- What must be proved?
- What evidence does he provide? Is it C-R-S?
- What analysis does he make? Does it make sense?

How much does your evaluation overlap?

Let's consolidate your assessment.

Debrief

Suggest a comprehensive thesis statement.

How much claims does it have?

What types of evidence support the claim? C-R-S?